Published Date:	Thursday 25th July, 2019	Publication:	The Hindu Business Line [New Delhi]
Journalist:	Bureau	Page No:	10

Affle (India) to raise up to ₹459 cr via IPO

The public issue will open on July 29

OUR BUREAU
Mumbai, July 24

Mobile marketing company Affle (India), the Indian unit of Microsoft-backed Affle Holdings, is planning to raise up to ₹459 crore through an initial public offering that will open for subscription on July 29.

The company has fixed a price band of ₹740-745 a share, with the IPO comprising a fresh issue of up to ₹90 crore and an offer-for-sale of up to 49,53,020 shares by Affle Holdings. The issue will close on July 31, the company said in a statement.

Affle (India) had received SEBI approval for an initial stake-sale in October 2018.

ICICI Securities, Nomura Financial Advisory and Securities (India) are the book running lead managers to the issue, while Karvy Fintech is the registrar. Following the IPO, the firm intends to list the shares on the BSE and the NSE.

The company intends to use the proceeds of the IPO for working capital requirements and general corporate purposes.

Affle India is part of Singapore-based Affle Holdings, in which Microsoft holds a 6.48 per cent stake. It is also backed by investors such as Ascent Capital, NGP Capital and Inventus Capital Partners.

The firm is a consumer intelligence-driven mobile marketing platform, which is used by business-to-consumer firms. According to the draft red herring prospectus, Malabar India Fund and Malabar Value Fund, collectively known as Malabar Investments, had acquired a 7.83 per cent stake for ₹136 crore in Affle (India) ahead of the IPO.

In September 2018, Affle had acquired Bengaluru-based Vizury Interactive Solutions' commerce business and brand in an undisclosed all-cash deal.

Anuj Khanna Sohum, MD, Affle (India)

Founded in 2008, Vizury is a data-driven mobile marketing company with three business lines — push messaging, re-targeting and financial products. Its commerce business is spread out across India, Middle East and Africa (MEA) and the US, among other geographies.

Prior to that, in March 2018, Affle (India) had acquired the 'Markt' platform to expand its online-to-offline (O2O) commerce business.